

CFP parcels with major canopy loss

Houghton & Keweenaw Counties, Michigan

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2026-09-17

Summary

Using Commercial Forest Parcel (CFP) data for 2020 and 2026 from the Michigan Department of Natural Resources alongside the USFS FIA Total Canopy Cover (TCC) dataset, I looked for parcels that had a canopy cover change > 20% between 2020 and 2026. All of the information below is for parcels that had the largest change in canopy cover.

Of 2,128 CFP parcels 20 acres, **72 parcels (~12,219 acres)** lost more than **20 percent** of mean tree canopy from 2020 to 2025. Almost all stayed **Forest Industry** by owner type — but most **changed legal name**, led by TRG Threshold → Verdant Timber.

Key numbers

Parcels with $\Delta\text{TCC} < -20$ percent	72 (3% of ranked parcels)
Acres (2020 attribute)	12,219
Still Forest Industry → Forest Industry	65 parcels
Owner type changed	4
Owner name changed (loose match)	65 (~10,709 ac)
Left CFP by 2026	0 of these 72
Median / max	Δ

General Parcel Size Distribution

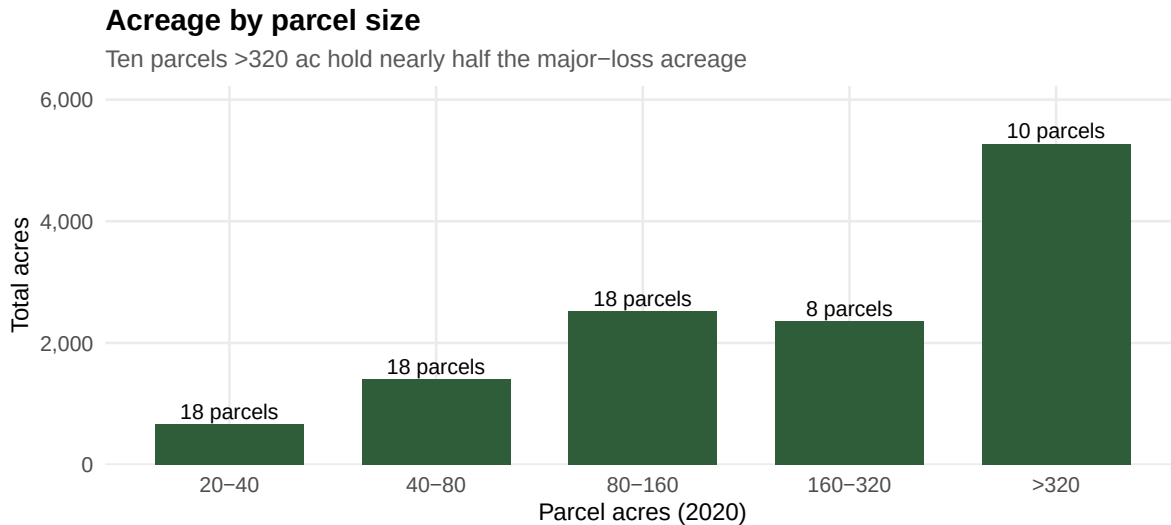


Figure 1: Size of the 72 major-loss parcels.

Parcel type and owner transitions for parcels with greatest canopy cover change

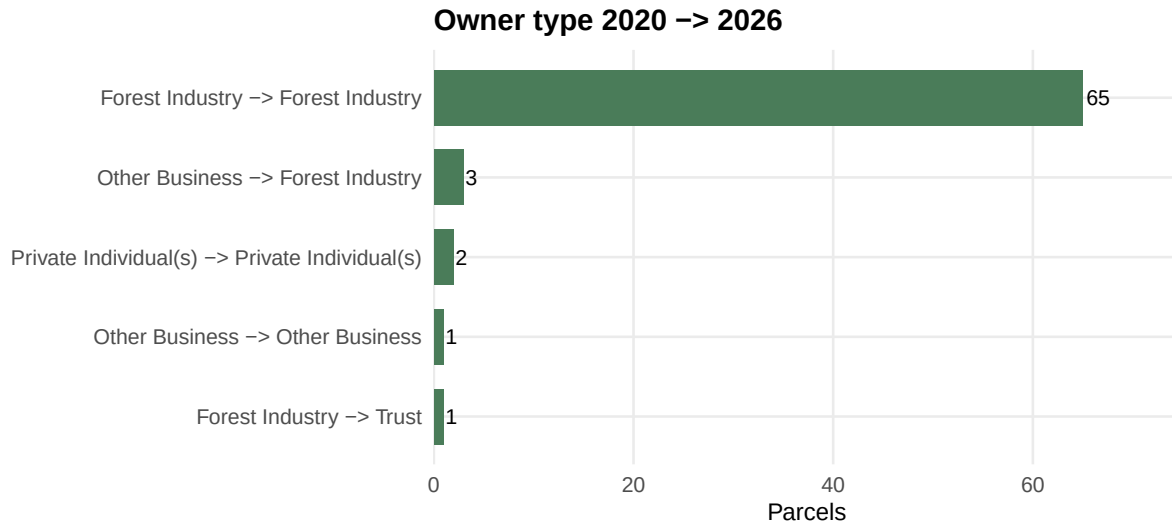


Figure 2: Ownership type continuity among major-loss parcels.

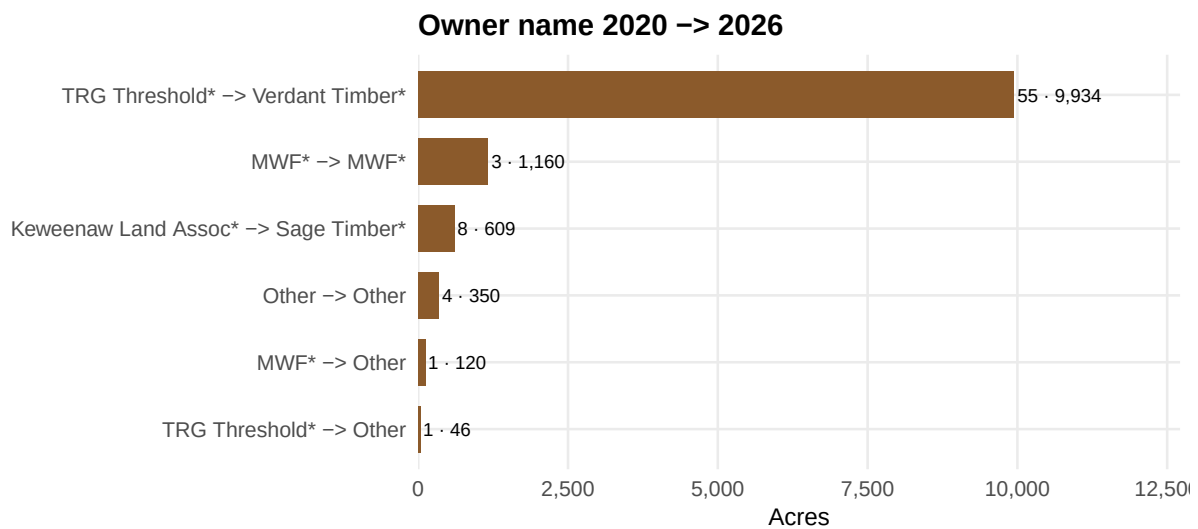


Figure 3: Ownership name continuity among major-loss parcels.

Canopy cover change

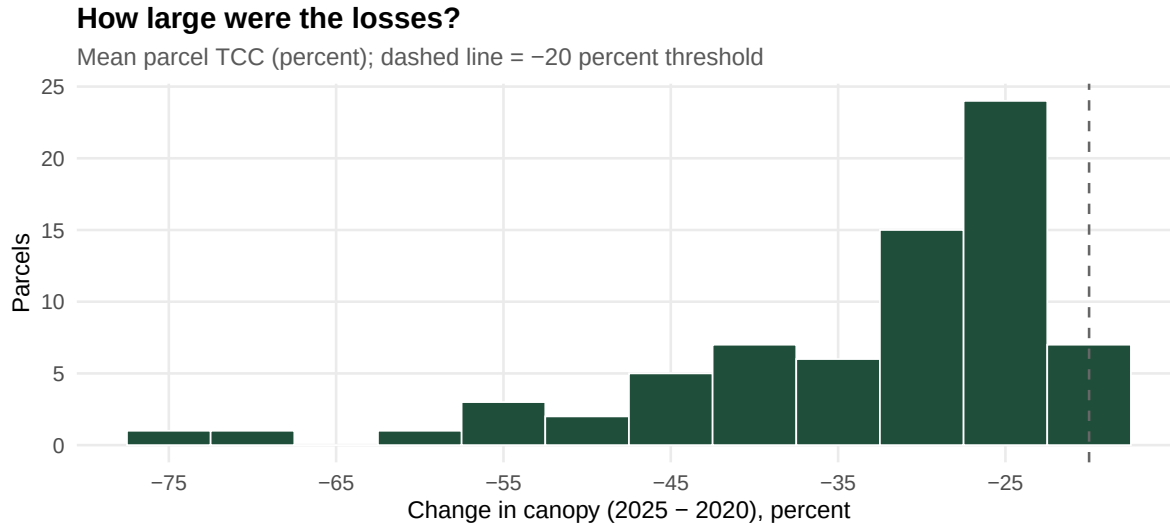


Figure 4: Distribution of canopy change (percent) for major-loss parcels.

Takeaway

The ~12,219 acres of **major canopy loss** are concentrated on **forest-industry CFP land that kept the forest industry type label**. Continuity of owner *type* masks substantial **legal-name turnover**, especially **TRG Threshold Timber → Verdant Timber** (~55 parcels / ~9,934 ac) and **Keweenaw Land Association → Sage Timber** (8 parcels / ~609 ac). None of these 72 parcels left the CFP between 2020 and 2026.

Methods (short)

- **Unit:** 2020 CFP parcels with attribute acres 20 (parid).
- **Canopy:** zonal mean USFS/NLCD TCC on the 30 m grid, **2020 vs 2025** (latest annual TCC; ownership snapshot is 2026).
- **Major loss:** mean $\Delta TCC < -20$ percent (72 of 2,128 ranked parcels).
- **Ownership:** 2020 owner_type / search_nam; 2026 OwnerTypeT / FullLegalN, joined on parid.
- **Name match:** loose string compare (case, punctuation, LLC/Inc stripped). Source table: data/processed/cfp_parcel_tcc. (scripts/09_cfp_parcel_tcc_change.R).